National Maintenance - Guideline

Owner: National Maintenance Admin

Department: National Maintenance Team

Applies to: All BAPS Swaminarayan Sanstha mandirs in Australia and New Zealand

Read with: National Maintenance Admin, State Maintenance Lead and Local Maintenance Lead – Roles & Responsibilities

Version Control

Version	Date	Effective Date	Author / Owner	Approved by	Summary of Changes
1.0	11/11/2026		National Maintenance Team		Initial Draft

1) Purpose

This guideline sets one national framework for how BAPS Swaminarayan Sanstha mandirs are maintained, so that every mandir is safe, compliant and in good working order. The National Maintenance Team leads and supports the local maintenance teams at every mandir across every state and territory.

a) Set one national standard for how mandir buildings, grounds, services and equipment are maintained.
b) Lead, guide and support the local maintenance teams, so each mandir delivers that standard.
c) Oversee major repair and maintenance works nationally.
d) Make sure every major work has the right permits, licences, approvals and insurances before it starts.
e) Protect the Sanstha's assets, its people and its reputation.
f) Develop technical skills at mandir level.
g) Strengthen samp within the team.
h) Earn Swami's eternal Rajipo through seva and samp.

2) Scope

This guideline covers the following assets and activities at owned and leased mandirs. For leased sites, it applies within what the lease makes the Sanstha responsible for.

a) **In scope**
    i) **Buildings and structures:** mandir halls, Sinhasan, shikhars and domes, roofs, facades, kitchens, offices, residences and sheds.
    ii) **Building services:** electrical, plumbing, gas, HVAC, fire safety systems, emergency lighting and lifts.
    iii) **Grounds:** car parks, driveways, fencing, drainage, signage and external lighting.
    iv) **Equipment and fit-out:** commercial kitchen equipment, furniture, stages, and festival and decoration equipment.
    v) **Maintenance types:** statutory and compliance maintenance, preventive maintenance, reactive repairs and lifecycle replacement.
b) **Out of scope** (handled by other departments, with the National Maintenance Team advising where needed)
    i) Property purchase, sale and leasing negotiations.
    ii) New-build mandir projects, which run under their own project governance.
    iii) Kitchen food-safety operations and day-to-day cleaning, except where they depend on equipment or building condition.

3) Team Structure and Reporting

A National Maintenance Admin heads a small national team of specialist leads, which supports the local maintenance team at each mandir.

Role	Volunteer	Focus
National Maintenance Admin	—	Leads the national team and all Local Maintenance Leads; owns the framework, budget and annual plan
National Maintenance Operations Lead	—	Work order system, action log, meeting papers, dashboards and KPIs
National State Maintenance Lead	—	Coordinates the State Maintenance Leads
State Maintenance Lead	Facility Admin or Maintenance Lead of the Type A mandir in each state	First point of contact for Local Maintenance Leads in the state; approves jobs of $1,001 – $5,000
National Maintenance Compliance & Permits Lead	—	Compliance register, permits, licences and the pre-start hold point
National Asset & Planned Maintenance Lead	—	Asset register, 12-month calendars and 7-year lifecycle plans
National Maintenance Contracts & Procurement Lead	—	Approved contractor list, service contracts and quoting
Local Maintenance Lead	One per mandir	Day-to-day maintenance of the mandir site

Reporting lines

a) The National Maintenance Admin reports to senior leadership and the AAC.
b) National leads report to the National Maintenance Admin.
c) State Maintenance Leads report to the National State Maintenance Lead for their country.
d) Local Maintenance Leads report to the National Maintenance Team for major maintenance work, through their State Maintenance Lead, and work closely with their Mandir Coordinator on site matters.

Composition

a) **National team:** the National Maintenance Admin and the national leads above. In a volunteer team, one person may hold more than one role.
b) **Local teams:** a Local Maintenance Lead plus volunteers sized to the site.
c) **Preferred skills:** engineering, trades and facilities.
d) Volunteers with trade licences may only do licensed work under their own licence and insurance, as approved by the National Maintenance Team.

4) National Team Roles

Each national role has a clear owner. The National Maintenance Admin, State Maintenance Lead and Local Maintenance Lead have their own Roles & Responsibilities documents; the other national leads are described here.

a) **National Maintenance Admin** – see National Maintenance Admin – Roles & Responsibilities.
b) **National Maintenance Operations Lead**
   i) Stands in for the National Maintenance Admin when they are away.
   ii) Runs the maintenance request and work order system, and the national action log.
   iii) Prepares meeting agendas, papers and minutes, and follows up actions.
   iv) Produces monthly dashboards and KPI reports.
c) **State Maintenance Lead** – see State Maintenance Lead – Roles & Responsibilities. Coverage: NSW, ACT, Victoria (including Tasmania), Queensland, Western Australia, South Australia (including Northern Territory) and New Zealand.
d) **National Maintenance Compliance & Permits Lead**
   i) Keeps the national compliance register (statutory tests, certificates, annual statements and due dates) for all mandirs.
   ii) Decides whether a job is major work and which permits, licences and approvals it needs.
   iii) Works with councils, certifiers, building surveyors and heritage bodies.
   iv) Signs off the pre-start checklist before any major work begins, and holds the authority to stop work that starts without it.
   v) Collects completion and compliance certificates and closes compliance items.
   vi) Alerts local teams 60 days before each compliance item falls due, and escalates overdue items.
e) **National Asset & Planned Maintenance Lead**
   i) Builds and maintains the national asset register.
   ii) Prepares each mandir's 12-month maintenance calendar and 7-year lifecycle plan.
   iii) Analyses condition reports to forecast replacements and budget needs.
   iv) Keeps drawings, manuals and warranties in the central document store.
f) **National Maintenance Contracts & Procurement Lead**
   i) Maintains the approved contractor list for each state, with licence and insurance checks.
   ii) Sets up and manages national or state service contracts.
   iii) Runs quoting for major jobs and checks quotes against the approved scope.
   iv) Reviews contractor performance every year.
   v) Makes sure procurement follows Sanstha policy and the CAPEX workflow.
g) **Local Maintenance Lead** – see Local Maintenance Lead – Roles & Responsibilities.

5) Major Maintenance Work

Major maintenance work is planned and approved by the National Maintenance Team. Any one of the following makes a job major maintenance work:

a) Structural work, extensions, demolition or changes to the building's layout or use.

b) Work that needs a development approval, complying development certificate, building permit or construction certificate from council, a private certifier or a building surveyor.
c) Work on or near a heritage-listed item or within a heritage area.
d) Electrical, plumbing, drainage or gas work beyond like-for-like minor repairs.
e) Work on major fire safety systems, essential safety measures, lifts or emergency exits.
f) Roof work, work at heights, scaffolding, or use of elevating work platforms and cranes, so that appropriate safety measures are taken.
g) Work that may disturb asbestos or other hazardous materials (any building built before 2004 is assumed to possibly contain asbestos until checked).
h) Hot work (welding, cutting, grinding) inside or near the building.
i) Tree removal or major pruning, new signage, changes to car parks, driveways or stormwater.
j) Any job above the CAPEX threshold, or any job that needs Board approval.
k) Any work at a leased mandir that needs landlord consent under the lease.

6) Permits, Licences and Approvals

No major work starts at any mandir until the National Maintenance Compliance & Permits Lead has confirmed in writing that every required permit, licence, approval and insurance is in place. This is a hold point: the local team, contractor and Mandir Coordinator may not override it.

Requirements differ between states, territories and councils. For every major job the national team confirms which of the following apply:

Item	Typically issued by	Responsibility
Plumbing, drainage and gas compliance certificates	Licensed plumber or gasfitter, lodged with state regulator	Contractor; checked by Local Maintenance Lead
Electrical certificate of compliance	Licensed electrician, lodged with state regulator	Contractor; checked by Local Maintenance Lead
Asbestos survey, licensed removal and clearance certificate	Licensed assessor and removalist	Local Maintenance Lead and WHS lead
Hot work, roof access and confined space permits	Mandir Coordinator	Local Maintenance Lead
Road, footpath, crane or skip bin permits	Local council or road authority	Contractor; checked by Local Maintenance Lead
Tree removal permit	Local council	Local Maintenance Lead
Landlord consent (leased sites)	Landlord or managing agent	Local Maintenance Lead
Insurer notification for significant works	BAPS Sanstha's insurer or broker	National Maintenance Admin

Contractor licences and insurances

Before a contractor starts any work, the team checks and keeps on file:

a) Current trade licence for the work being done (electrical, plumbing, gas, building, refrigeration, asbestos removal, fire protection), checked against the state licensing register.

b) High risk work licences where needed (for example scaffolding, elevating work platforms over 11 m, forklifts, cranes).
c) Public liability insurance of at least $20 million for work at public venues.
d) Workers compensation insurance, or proof the contractor is a sole trader with their own cover.
e) Safe Work Method Statements (SWMS) for high-risk construction work, and site induction records.
f) Working with Children Check where workers may have contact with children during mandir activities.

Pre-start checklist (sign-off required)

☐ Scope of work approved by the National Maintenance Team
☐ Funding approved through the CAPEX workflow
☐ All required permits and approvals obtained or confirmed not needed, with reasons recorded
☐ Contractor licences and insurances checked and filed
☐ Asbestos register checked and hazardous materials managed
☐ SWMS, site induction and site safety plan in place
☐ Mandir Coordinator informed; work in or near the Sinhasan arranged respectfully and in consultation with the Pujarishri
☐ Timing checked against the festival and event calendar
☐ Devotees, neighbours and landlord notified where needed
☐ Sign-off by the local maintenance team is recorded

On completion

The team collects and files all completion certificates, compliance certificates, warranties, manuals and as-built drawings, updates the asset register, and closes the job in the maintenance system.

7) National and Local Responsibilities

The National Maintenance Team sets the standard, plans major maintenance, oversees delivery and checks compliance. Local teams carry out the work at each mandir.

Area	National team	Local team
Standards and procedures	Sets and updates them	Follows them; suggests improvements
Planned maintenance	Prepares 12-month and 7-year plans	Delivers the plan on site
Minor repairs	Sets delegation limits; monitors	Arranges and completes
Major work	Approves scope, permits, funding and contractor	Raises the need; supports on site
Permits and licences	Confirms and signs off before start	Provides site information; enforces on site
Contractors	Approves list and contracts	Books from approved list; supervises on site
Compliance testing	Tracks register; sends reminders	Arranges access; files certificates
Emergencies	Escalation support, insurer liaison	First response; makes site safe
Budget	Sets and tracks national budget	Keeps spending within local allocation

8) Priorities and Response Times

Every maintenance request is given one of four priority levels, which sets how fast it is handled and who must be told. The response times below are proposed starting points for the National Maintenance Team to confirm.

Priority	Examples	Make safe / respond	Notify
P1 Emergency	Fire system fault, gas leak, flooding, power loss during an event, structural damage, security breach	Immediately; contractor on site within 4 hours	State Maintenance Lead and National Maintenance Admin at once; Mandir Coordinator
P2 Urgent	Kitchen equipment or HVAC failure, roof leak, broken toilets, failed emergency light	Within 48 hours	State Maintenance Lead within 24 hours; Mandir Coordinator
P3 Routine	Minor repairs, painting, fixtures, small grounds jobs	Within 14 days	Recorded in monthly report
P4 Planned	Scheduled servicing, lifecycle replacements, improvement works	As per maintenance calendar	Recorded in monthly report

9) Escalation Path

Issues are resolved at the lowest level that can resolve them, and escalated promptly when they cannot.

a) Local Maintenance Lead resolves within local delegation.
b) If not resolved, or beyond local delegation: State Maintenance Lead.
c) If not resolved, or a P1 event, major work or compliance risk: National Maintenance Admin.
d) If it needs funds beyond delegation, affects safety at a national level, or carries legal or reputational risk: AAC and the Board.

10) Financial Approvals

All spending follows the BAPS Sanstha's CAPEX authorisation workflow and financial delegations. Proposed maintenance limits, to be confirmed against the Board's delegations:

Spend per job	Approved by
Up to local limit ($2,000 for Type A and B centres; $1,000 for Type C centres)	Local Maintenance Lead, within local allocation
$1,001 – $5,000 (above the mandir's local limit)	State Maintenance Lead, with the Mandir Coordinator informed
Capital and major works	CAPEX workflow: Submitter, Department Admin, Mandir Coordinator, Board
Items at or below $10,000	Board consent agenda, via the CAPEX workflow

11) Meetings

The National Maintenance Team meets every local team regularly, and calls extra meetings whenever an emergency, a major work or a compliance risk needs it.

a) **Regular national meeting**
   i) **Who:** National team and all Local Maintenance Leads (or briefed delegates).
   ii) **When:** once a month, when called by the National Maintenance Team.
   iii) **Where:** online (for example Microsoft Teams), so every state and territory can join.
   iv) **Papers:** local monthly reports due 5 working days before; agenda and dashboard sent 2 working days before.
   v) **Minutes and action log:** circulated within 3 working days, with an owner and due date for every action.

b) **Standing agenda**
   i) Safety first: incidents, near misses, hazards.
   ii) Actions from last meeting.
   iii) National dashboard: work orders, planned maintenance, compliance, spend.
   iv) Compliance items due in the next 90 days and any overdue items.
   v) Major works: status, permits, approvals and upcoming starts.
   vi) Regional updates from State Maintenance Leads (by exception).
   vii) Upcoming festivals and events affecting maintenance.
   viii) Lessons learned, good suppliers and training.
   ix) Decisions and new actions.

c) **Ad hoc meetings** – the National Maintenance Admin, or any State Maintenance Lead, can call one with one or more local teams when:
   i) An emergency or serious incident occurs (within 24 hours for Priority 1 events).
   ii) A major work is about to start (pre-start meeting) or reaches key stages.
   iii) A compliance item is overdue, or a regulator, council or insurer raises an issue.
   iv) Preparation is needed before a major festival or event.
   v) A local team asks for help with a problem it cannot solve.

d) **Other regular meetings**
   i) **National team meeting:** fortnightly or monthly, before the national meeting.
   ii) **Site visit and condition inspection:** each mandir, in person as and when needed.
   iii) **Annual planning workshop:** sets next year's maintenance calendar, budget and priorities.

12) Reporting and Records

Regular reporting keeps the national team, AAC and Board informed, and central records keep every mandir audit-ready.

a) **Monthly local report** (one page, from each Local Maintenance Lead)
   i) Open and completed work orders, with any overdue items.
   ii) Planned maintenance completed vs scheduled.

iii) Compliance items due in the next 90 days.
iv) Incidents, near misses and safety concerns.
v) Proposed major work or capital needs.
vi) Spend against local allocation.
vii) Help needed from the National Maintenance Team.

Reporting rhythm

Report	Audience	Frequency
Local monthly report	National team	Monthly
National dashboard	Local teams, national team	Monthly
Leadership report: condition, compliance, spend, risks	AAC and Board	Quarterly
Annual maintenance report and next year's plan	Board	Yearly

Records kept centrally

a) Asset register and condition reports.
b) Maintenance calendars, work orders and completion records.
c) Compliance register, test results and certificates.
d) Permits, approvals, completion certificates and pre-start checklists.
e) Contractor licences, insurances, SWMS and inductions.
f) Asbestos and hazardous materials registers.
g) Meeting minutes and action logs.
h) Drawings, manuals and warranties.

Records are kept in a shared, access-controlled location (for example SharePoint), with access for Local Maintenance Leads, and retained for at least 7 years, or longer where law or the lease requires.

13) Key Performance Indicators

The National Maintenance Team measures each mandir and the network as a whole against these KPIs, reported monthly to local teams and quarterly to the AAC.

KPI	Target
Statutory compliance items completed on time	100%
Major works started with full permit sign-off	100%
P1 emergencies made safe within target	100%
P2 urgent jobs completed within 48 hours	90% or more
Planned maintenance tasks completed on schedule	90% or more
Annual condition inspections completed	All mandirs
Contractors on site with verified licence and insurance	100%
Monthly local reports submitted on time	95% or more
Maintenance spend within budget	Within 5% per mandir

KPI	Target
Maintenance-related safety incidents	Zero serious incidents; all reported and reviewed

14) RACI Summary

The RACI shows who is Responsible (R), Accountable (A), Consulted (C) and Informed (I) for each key activity.

Activity	National Admin	State Maint. Lead	Compl. & Permits	Local Lead	Mandir Coord.	Board
National framework and standards	A	C	C	C	I	I
Monthly national meeting	A/R	R	C	R	–	–
Annual condition inspection	A	R	C	R	I	–
12-month maintenance calendar	A	C	C	R	I	–
Routine and minor repairs	I	A	–	R	I	–
Emergency response	A	R	C	R	I	–
Major work scope	A	R	C	C	C	–
Permits and licences before major work	A	C	R	C	I	–
Contractor licence and insurance checks	A	C	R	R (on site)	–	–
Statutory compliance testing	A	C	R	R	I	–
CAPEX submissions	R	C	C	C	A (site)	A (approval)
Annual maintenance budget	R	C	C	C	C	A

Open items to confirm

☐ Maintenance system to use for work orders and the asset register.